

Overall, the UDC protocol is a lightweight "door bell" message sent by a Commissionee. There is no state or session associated with UDC protocol messages, allowing the recipient to choose to support messages received from different sources at the same time, or choose to ignore messages received while the processing of an earlier message has not completed. The UDC protocol consists of an **Identification Declaration** which provides the Commissionee's `_matterc._udp` DNS-SD service instance name. In addition, **Identification Declaration** MAY include optional information relating to the requested commissioning session.

Upon receiving this message, the Commissioner MAY query the DNS-SD service instance indicated in the **Identification Declaration**, including TXT records, in order to obtain additional information about the Commissionee, MAY obtain the corresponding Onboarding Payload or Passcode from the user for this Commissionee, and MAY initiate the commissioning process with it.

The Commissioner MAY send a **CommissionerDeclaration** to the **Identification Declaration** message sender's source IP and Port. The **CommissionerDeclaration** provides information to a Commissionee indicating the Commissioner's pre-commissioning state, which MAY be used by the Commissionee to simplify the Passcode entry user experience.

Upon receiving this message, the Commissionee MAY provide instructions to the user about how to proceed to the next steps in the commissioning process, for example, by displaying a Passcode to the user, and instructing them to provide it to the Commissioner.

While a sequence of these messages between Commissionee and Commissioner can be used to achieve a specific user experience, as the examples below illustrate, the processing of each message is expected to stand alone and not be dependent upon other messages in the sequence. For this reason there is no use of session or exchange identifiers, and no encryption of the messages. Consequently, there are no guarantees of behavior or acknowledgements, information contained in messages SHOULD be assumed to be visible to the network, and messages SHALL NOT contain private or sensitive information.

The Commissionee and Commissioner SHALL enforce rate limiting of these messages and provide the option for the user to disable handling of them (either temporarily or until manually re-enabled). For example, a rate limiting algorithm of accepting no more than 20 messages (not including retries) in a 10 minute period is recommended.

One possible user journey for this feature is described in [Commissioner Discovery from an Existing Device](#).



Figure 43. Overview of the UDC Protocol Identification Declaration message

The Commissionee is the Initiator and the Commissioner is the Recipient of the IdentificationDeclaration message.